

Cambridge IGCSE™

ENGLISH AS A SECOND LANGUAGE

0511

Paper 1 Reading and Writing

Unit 19

50 minutes

You must answer on the answer card.

No additional materials are needed.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer all questions.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do not write on any bar codes.
- Dictionaries are not allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 30.

Exercise 1

Read the article about the growing trend of "retro" living, and then answer the questions.

The Retro Revival

In recent years, there has been a noticeable surge in the popularity of all things retro. From fashion and music to technology and interior design, young people, particularly those from Generation Z, are developing a deep fascination with the aesthetics and culture of the past. This isn't just a fleeting trend; it represents a significant cultural shift driven by a complex set of factors.

One major driver is the overwhelming nature of modern digital life. The constant connectivity, the pressure to maintain a perfect online persona, and the sheer volume of information can be exhausting. For many, the pre-digital era—or at least a romanticised version of it—represents a simpler time. This nostalgia is not for the past itself, but for a perceived slower pace of life where interactions were more genuine and less mediated by screens. The 'Y2K' aesthetic, for example, harks back to a time before social media became all-consuming, providing a comforting sense of simplicity and tactile experiences.

Furthermore, there is a growing desire for authenticity. In a world of mass production and imitation goods, vintage items and analogue experiences offer a tangible connection to the past. A vinyl record or a classic film camera provides a more hands-on, engaging experience than their digital counterparts. This desire also manifests in a preference for sustainable consumption. Instead of buying new, mass-produced merchandise, many are turning to second-hand shops and vintage markets, deeming it as a more environmentally responsible way to acquire goods. This reduces the demand for new resources and challenges the throwaway culture of modern consumerism.

However, this movement is not without its contradictions. Critics argue that this is a form of privilege, as it often ignores the genuine struggles and inequalities of the past. Psychologists suggest that while a touch of nostalgia can be beneficial, an

excessive desire to 'rewind time' can be an unhealthy way to cope with present-day anxieties. Ultimately, the trend highlights a fundamental human desire for connection and meaning in an increasingly complex world. It serves as a reminder that while technology offers incredible progress, the need for genuine human connection and a sense of belonging remains timeless.

[Total: 8]

Question 1

According to the article, what are young people intrigued by?

..... [1]

Question 2

What does the article suggest the pre-digital era symbolizes for many people?

..... [1]

Question 3

What does 'Y2K' offer, according to the text?

..... [1]

Question 4

Why are vintage items and analogue experiences appealing to some people?

..... [1]

Question 5

How does buying second-hand merchandise support a more environmentally responsible lifestyle?

..... [1]

Question 6

What is one potential negative consequence of an excessive desire for the past, as mentioned by psychologists?

..... [1]

Question 7

What fundamental human craving is this trend ultimately said to highlight?

..... [1]

[Total: 7]

Exercise 2

Read the article about four young people (A-D) who are planning a career as a pilot. Then answer Questions

Young pilots

Four young people talk about their love of flying

A Sally

I fell in love with planes at high school. I always knew I wanted to work for an airline in some way, but it wasn't until I completed a school project on how planes fly that I decided I wanted to become a pilot. I really enjoyed being able to make even just a model plane fly, so much so that I asked for flying lessons for my 16th birthday. I was lucky. My instructor was really positive about my abilities and, if he hadn't encouraged me, I'd never have applied to pilot school. I'm still fascinated by the physics of flying, and without the knowledge of how it all works, I'm convinced that I wouldn't be able to achieve my ambition. I also pay special attention to new types of aircraft. I hope that's something that will help me stand out from the crowd when I start applying for jobs.

B Chuck

I come from a family of pilots. My father and grandfather both flew planes in the army, and I grew up seeing their medals and going to aeroplane museums with them. Their bravery has always impressed me, and made me want to follow the same path in my flying career. Although they never said so, I think they felt very proud. After a while, though, I realised I was much more interested in commercial airlines than joining the army. At first, I worried how my family might feel about this, but then I saw how delighted my parents were after I landed my first flight when I was just 17. I'm now focused on getting the qualifications I need as an airline pilot. I believe it'll mean I can both please my family by partly following tradition as well as do something that matters to me.

C Alicia

I first went on a small plane when I was eight. I was so worried that I cried during take-off, but once we were up, I was fascinated. The advantage of flying in a small plane is that kids can sometimes go up and meet the pilots, and I was so impressed by their abilities. One of them gave me a tiny aeroplane badge, which I've worn every time I've flown since. It reminds me of the high standards I want to maintain when I become a pilot. I loved how those pilots sounded confident and calm, which is something I'll admit I need to work on. Every time I heard the pilot's voice through the speakers, it felt like a friend telling me I didn't need to worry about safety. I'd love to be able to give others that same feeling, which is why I'm drawn to a career as a pilot.

D Gary

Despite being born into a family with a history of producing pilots, it took me a while to appreciate the appeal, and I really wasn't into science to begin with. But I remember when Dad got his pilot's licence. Seeing his happiness was when everything started making sense, and I finally realised what I wanted to do. I started taking flying lessons soon afterwards. For me, flying provides an escape from the stresses of things like studying - nothing else really compares. That's why flying isn't just another career option for me - it's the only one - and it's why I'll keep working at it until I'm the best pilot I can be. When flying, you're always learning, there's always something you can improve - that's a huge reason for being a pilot. One thing that

makes a great pilot is good communication, and despite a slow start, I think I've made that one of my main strengths.

For each statement, write the correct letter, **A, B, C or D**, on the line.

Which person ...

1. admits they were concerned about causing disappointment? [1]
2. emphasises how important it is for them to understand the science of flight? [1]
3. refers to an encounter that still inspires them today? [1]
4. thinks their choice of career represents a good compromise? [1]
5. suggests they would struggle to find satisfaction in any other job? [1]
6. mentions something that could provide them with an advantage over competitors? [1]
7. talks about their initial lack of interest in following a tradition? [1]
8. appreciates the support that gave them the confidence to continue with their plans? [1]
9. mentions an ability they recognise is in need of improvement? [1]

Exercise 3

Read the article about the reasons for the popularity of retro living, and then complete the notes.

The Allure of the Past

The modern world is defined by its rapid pace and **relentless** technological advancement. While these developments bring numerous benefits, they also create a sense of unease. The constant stream of notifications, the pressure of online social comparison, and the sheer volume of information can lead to significant stress. This has fuelled a powerful cultural movement: the revival of vintage and retro trends.

Young people, in particular, are rejecting the complexity of modern life in favour of the perceived simplicity and **authenticity** of the past.

This isn't simply about wearing old clothes or listening to vinyl records. It reflects a deeper desire to unplug from the digital world and engage with more tangible experiences. A key part of this is the appeal of analogue items. Unlike digital files, a vintage camera or a classic board game provides a tactile interaction. It allows people to connect with objects in a way that is impossible with their digital **counterparts**. This longing for something real and physical is a direct response to the increasingly virtual nature of our lives.

Furthermore, this fascination with the past is a form of comfort. The current global landscape is uncertain, and looking back to a simpler time—often viewed through rose-tinted glasses—offers psychological stability. Psychologists suggest that nostalgia can be a powerful coping mechanism. However, some experts warn against idealising the past too much. They argue that people may be yearning for a time that never truly existed, ignoring the genuine problems of those eras. Ultimately, while the retro trend may seem superficial, it highlights a crucial human need: the desire for genuine connection, a sense of community, and a slower, more meaningful lifestyle.

Imagine you are going to give a talk about the retro trend to your classmates. Use words from the article to help you write some notes.

Make short notes under each heading.

Reasons for the retro trend:

1. [1]
2. [1]
3. [1]

Potential problems with the retro trend:

4. [1]
5. [1]

Synonyms

6. Relentless_____
7. Authenticity_____
8. Counterparts_____

Exercise 4

Read the blog post by Max, who is planning to start his own blog, and then answer the questions.

Starting a blog has been on my mind for a while now. I'm fascinated by the world of vintage fashion, and I feel like it's a topic that isn't covered in the right way. Most blogs focus on expensive designer items that are out of reach for most people. I want to create a space dedicated to real, everyday vintage finds. The charm of rummaging through a charity shop and discovering a unique piece of clothing, a garment with a history, is something I want to share.

I remember the moment that solidified this idea. I was in a small second-hand store and found a 1970s leather jacket for an incredibly low price. The feel of the leather, the unique stitching—it was an authentic piece of history. I felt a surge of excitement that I knew I wanted to capture and pass on. That's the genuine experience I want to focus on, not just showcasing expensive items.

My goal is to create a blog that is a source of inspiration for beginners. I want to show how to style vintage clothing without looking like you're wearing a costume. I'll avoid just showing photos of the merchandise; instead, I'll give practical advice on how to mix vintage items with modern pieces to create a unique, wearable look. I will also focus on sustainable consumption, highlighting why choosing second-hand is a more responsible choice.

Of course, there are challenges. The main one is the sheer effort of being consistent. Finding good content takes time and, unlike other bloggers, I can't just buy new stock every week. I will have to be creative and make do with what I find. Also, I need to work on my photography skills to make the items look as good as they do in

person. But I'm up for the challenge! This is something I'm genuinely passionate about, and I'm confident I can make it work.

Question 1

What does Max say most fashion blogs focus on?

- A The history of vintage clothing.
- B How to find items in charity shops.
- C Items that are very expensive to buy.
- D How to be more sustainable.

Question 2

When describing the moment he found the leather jacket, Max says he felt...

- A confused by its low price.
- B a strong desire to share the experience.
- C uncertain about its authenticity.
- D anxious about starting a blog.

Question 3

Max's main purpose in creating the blog is to...

- A become famous.
- B make money from vintage merchandise.
- C provide useful guidance for others.
- D criticise the fashion industry.

Question 4

What does the word "One" in line 21 refer to?

- A Finding good content.
- B Being consistent.
- C The sheer effort.
- D Improving photography skills.

Question 5

What is Max's overall attitude towards starting this blog?

- A Hesitant and unsure.
- B Excited but worried about the future.
- C Determined and optimistic.
- D Overwhelmed by the potential challenges.

Question 6

What is Max planning to do regarding his photography?

- A Find a professional photographer to help.
- B He is not concerned about photography.
- C It is not an important part of his blog.
- D It is a skill he wants to improve.

END OF TEST